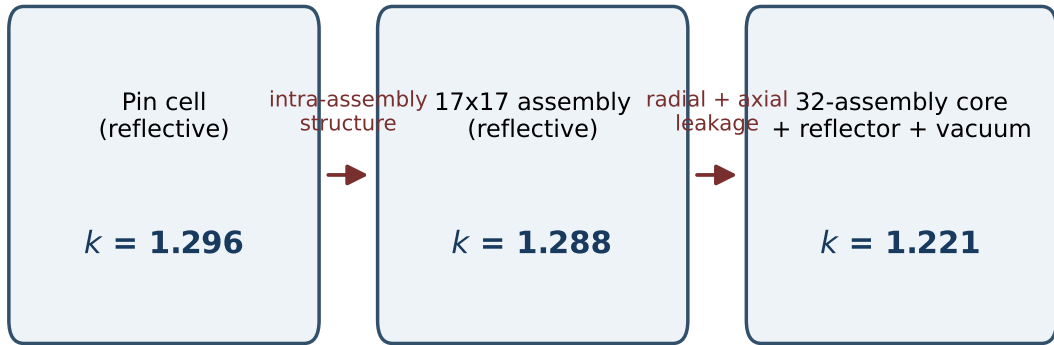




k_{∞} (infinite medium) $\rightarrow k_{\text{eff}}$ (finite core): each geometric step opens a leakage path and lowers multiplication